

INDIA TODAY

www.indiatoday.com

Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie
Chief Executive Officer: Ashish Bagga

Editor: Prabhu Chawla

Managing Editors: Raj Chengappa, Dilip Bobb, Shankar Aiyar

Executive Editors: Kaveree Bamzai, S. Prasannarajan

Deputy Editors: Farzand Ahmed, Damayanti Datta, Ashok K. Damodaran,
S. Kalidas, Sharda Ugra

Senior Editors: Malini Bhupta (Mumbai),
Amarnath K. Menon (Hyderabad)

Photo Editor: Bandeep Singh

Art Editor: Sapnna Kapoor

Associate Editors: Saurabh Shukla, Uday Mahurkar (Ahmedabad),
Ramesh Vinayak (Chandigarh)

Assistant Editors: S. Sahaya Ranjit, Priya Sahgal, Sandeep Unnithan,
Subhash Mishra (Lucknow)

Special Correspondents: Kimi Dangor (Mumbai), Rohit Parihar (Jaipur),
Neeraj Mishra (Delhi), Nirmala Ravindran (Bangalore),
M.G. Radhakrishnan (Thiruvananthapuram)

Principal Correspondents: Satarupa Bhattacharjya, Puja Mehra, Nandini Vaish,
BANGALORE: Stephen David, BHOPAL: Ambresh Mishra
KOLKATA: Swagata Sen, MUMBAI: Prerana Thakurdesai

Senior Correspondents: Aditi Pai (Mumbai)

Copy Desk: Shalini S. Sharma (Assistant Editor), Paramita Chatterjee,
Kaushik Deka, Sangram Keshari Parhi, Gaurav Rajkhowa, V. Shoba,
Rahul Tewari, Priya Verma, Anju Yadav

Photo Department: Hemant Chawla, Sipra Das, Yasbanti Negi,
Sumeet Inder Singh, Ishan Tankha, Ravi Sahani, AHMEDABAD: Shailesh Raval,
BANGALORE: Gireesh G.V., CHENNAI: H.K. Rajashekar, MUMBAI: Mandar Deodhar,
Shriya Patil, Bhaskar Paul

Rashmi Hajela (Chief Photo Researcher)

Infographics and Illustrations: Saurabh Singh

Art Department: Madhu Bhaskar (Associate Art Director), Ranjita Bhattacharji,
Vandana Nayar (Deputy Art Directors), Rashmi Ajmani, Vanita Arora,
Pushvinder Kaur, Jyoti Singh

Production Department: Surinder Hastu (Chief of Production),
Harish Aggarwal, Naveen Gupta

Associate Publishers: Malcolm D. Mistry (Impact)
Umesh Kumar (Marketing)

IMPACT TEAM

Director (Impact): Manoj Sharma

Senior General Manager: Anil Fernandes (West & South)

Head (Impact): Ashok Bindra (North)

General Managers: Kaustav Chatterjee (East),
Carl Avari (Bangalore)

Assistant General Manager: V. Somasundaram (Chennai)

Consumer Marketing Services: Poonam Sangha, Senior General Manager

Newsstand Sales: Vivek Gaur, Executive Director

D.V.S. Rama Rao, Senior General Manager (National Sales)

C.V. Vaidyalingam, Senior General Manager (South)

Vinod Das, General Manager (North)

Rajesh Menon, General Manager (West)

Rajeev Gandhi, Regional Manager (East)

OPERATIONS: S. Sridhar, General Manager



Volume XXXII Number 29; For the week July 17-23, 2007, released on July 16

● Editorial Office Living Media India Ltd. F-14/15, Connaught Place New Delhi 110001; Phones: 23315801-4;

Fax: 23316180; Cable: Livmedia, New Delhi

● Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (UP)-201301;

Phones: Toll-free number: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines), 951207 2479900 from Delhi and

Faridabad; (0120) 2479900 from Rest of India (Monday-Friday, 10 a.m.-6 p.m.); Fax: (0120) 4076080;

e-mail: ircar@indiatoday.com; Mumbai: 022-24444233-6; Fax: 24444358 ● Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to

General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, 201 Competent House, F-14, Middle Circle, Connaught Place,

New Delhi ● Regd. Office: K-9 Connaught Circus, New Delhi 110001 ● Impact Offices: Trade Centre, 2nd Floor,

Kamala City, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai 400013; Phone: 24983355; Fax: 24982266 ● Hamilton

House, 1-A, Connaught Place, New Delhi 110001; Phone: 23352233; Fax: 23327330 ● 98-A, Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai,

2nd Floor, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004; Phones: 28478526-41; Telex: 041-6177 Into In; Fax: 28472178; Cable:

Livmedia Chennai ● 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones:

22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; Cable: Livmedia, Bangalore ● 52, Jawaharlal Nehru Road,

4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; Cable: Livmedia, Kolkata ● 6-3-8857/B,

Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23401000, 23402481, 23410982, 23411498;

Fax: 23403484 ● J9/1045, Karakkatt Road, Kochi 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058; Fax: 2377059

● 2/C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchwadi, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006;

Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293

● Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is

prohibited. Printed and published by Ashish Bagga on behalf of Living Media India Ltd. Printed at Thomson Press

India Ltd., 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007 (Haryana), at Thomson Press India Ltd.,

A-9, Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, District Kancheepuram-603209, (Tamil Nadu), and at Thomson Press

India Ltd., Plot No. 5-SA, TTC Industrial Area, Thane, Belapur Road, Airoli, Navi Mumbai-400708, (Maharashtra).

Published at K-9, Connaught Circus, New Delhi-110001.

● India Today does not take responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

As it so happened, I was in London on the day of the failed attack on the city which was followed the next day by an attack on the Glasgow airport. I remember quietly hoping that none of the attackers would be an Indian and was somewhat relieved when initial reports suggested that the Glasgow attacker was of Middle Eastern origin. But that was not to be.

Brothers Kafeel and Sabeel Ahmed, implicated in the Glasgow plot, ironically, come from what is internationally India's best-known city, the country's IT capital—Bangalore. A member of their extended family, Mohammed Haneef is being investigated for his role in the plot to blow up a West End nightclub by detonating a parked Mercedes packed with firebombs. This is the first time that anyone born and bred in India has been implicated in an incident of international terrorism.

What is most baffling and worrisome for India is that neither the Ahmed brothers nor Haneef fit any conventional profile of an extremist. They do not come from the poor, ghettoised, alienated sections of society. The Ahmeds' doctor parents had enough resources to put one son through medical college and have one complete an engineering degree. Their cousin Haneef followed an identical path. To the world they were quiet, studious young men. Yet within years of going overseas for further studies and employment, they became radicalised enough to be willing accomplices in a plan as horrific as this.

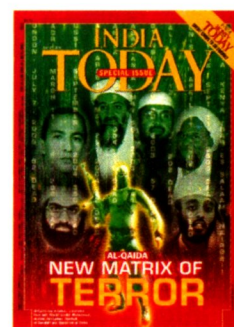
There is much that is unknown about the details of their radicalisation but going by the evidence of this case, there is a strong possibility that Al Qaeda cells are active in India. Our Parliament, commuter trains and crowded market places have already been attacked. This knowledge, that Al Qaeda has opened shop, will only reinforce a sense of vulnerability in India's public spaces.

Our cover story looks at this new dimension of terror, one with a direct Indian connection. Our bureaus in Delhi and Bangalore dissect the trail of the plot hatched and profile the doctors of death. Security expert Jason Burke, who has written a book on the Al Qaeda, explains the phenomenon of 'Londonistan' or how one of the world's most cosmopolitan cities became a training centre for terrorists. In London, Aditi Khanna speaks to South Asian professionals in the UK and how the incident has changed their lives.

Speaking at the National Press Club in Washington exactly a year ago, Prime Minister Manmohan Singh had said, "We have 150 million citizens who practise the faith of Islam. And I say it with some pride... that not one of them has joined the ranks of these gangs like the Al Qaeda or other terrorist outfits". Sadly, Mr Prime Minister, that is no longer true and we should all be very worried.

Aroon Purie

(Aroon Purie)



Our July 2005 cover